Compare two pages – side by side, overlaid or with a curtain

In **compare mode** ODV shows two pages side by side. You can fine-tune each page on its own – zoom, position, rotation and image – lay the pages on top of each other with transparency, or drag a border between them to see whether they match. Nothing you set is saved: it lasts until you load new documents, and the documents in the archive are never changed.

This guide belongs with Getting started with OpenDocViewer. The pictures show a made-up test document, in the Swedish interface; the button names here are the English ones.
Download the guide as PDF.

Good to know: everything in this guide is included from the start, but your organisation may have switched parts of it off – see section 7. If a button described here is missing, that is probably why.

1. Open the comparison and pick the pages

2. Calibrate – so that the pages line up

3. Fine-tune each page

4. Lay the pages on top of each other (overlay)

5. Drag a border between the pages (curtain)

6. Print from the comparison

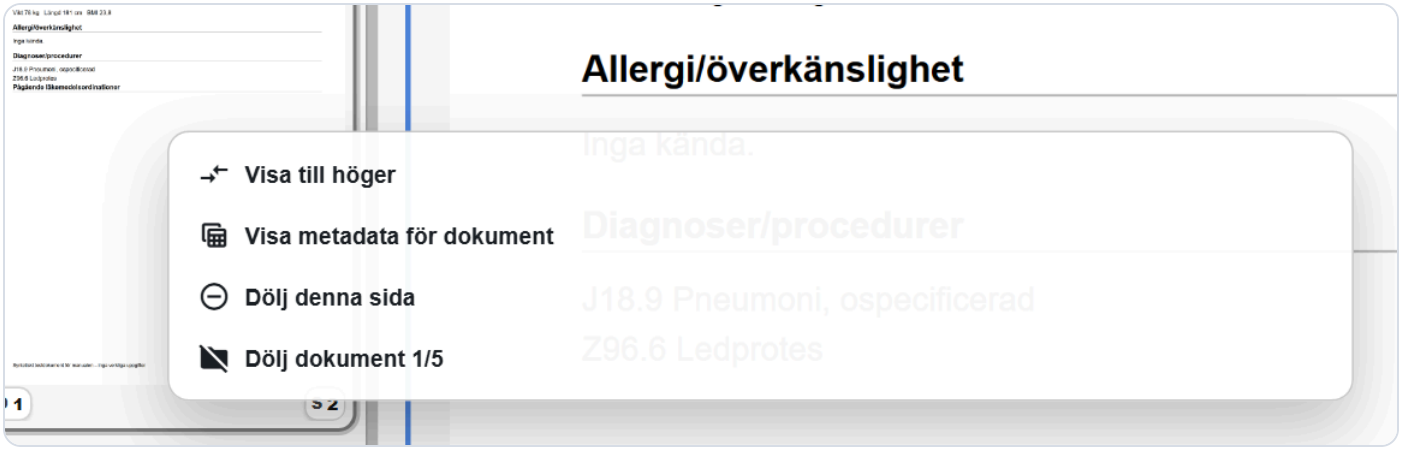
7. What your organisation may have switched off

1. Open the comparison and pick the pages

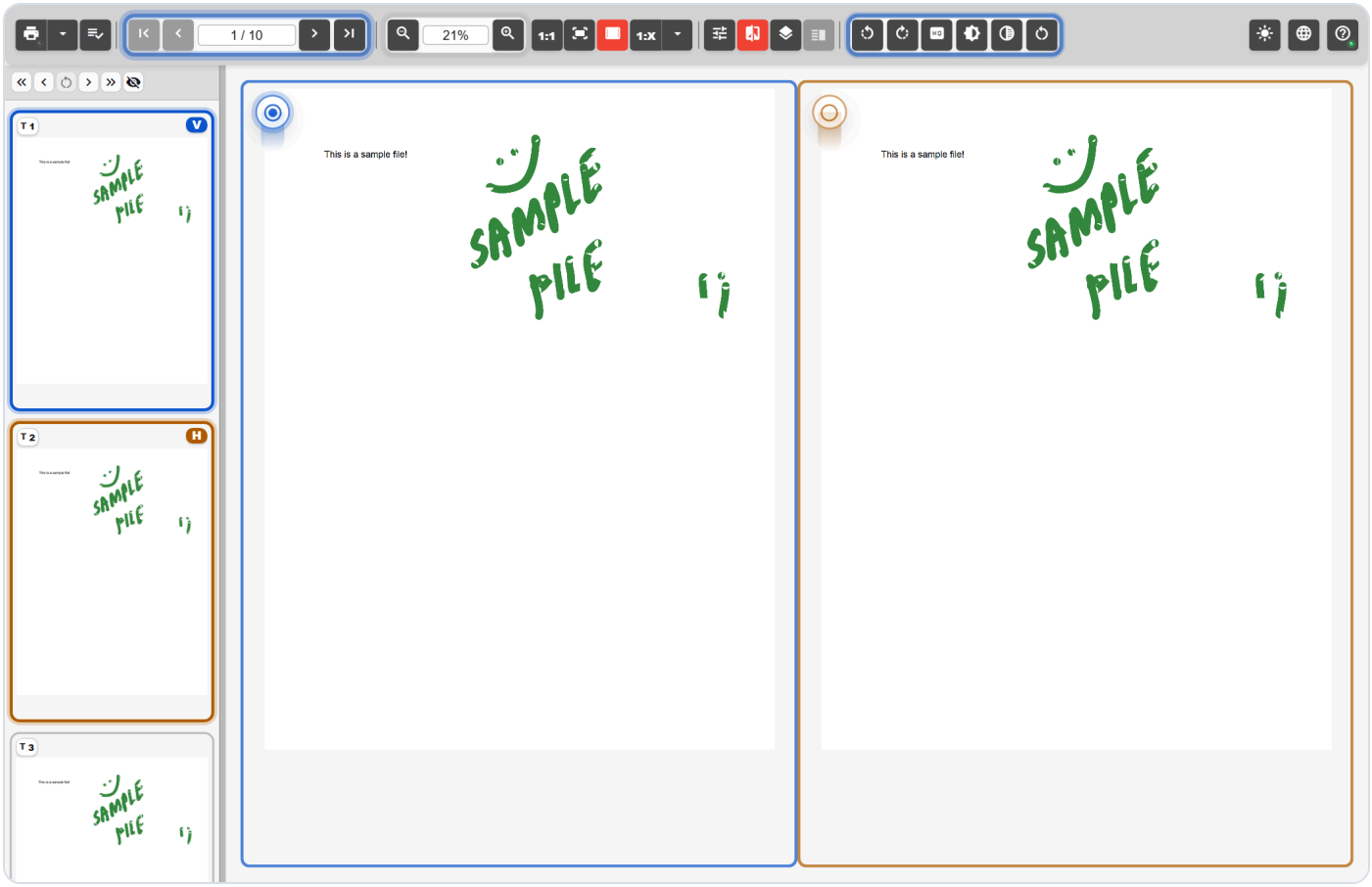
Click the **compare button** in the toolbar (*Enable compare mode*). The page you are looking at moves to the left with a **blue frame**, and a second page is shown on the right with an **orange frame**. The first time it is the same page in both places; later, the page you last compared with comes back on the right. The right page becomes the active one.

Choose which page to show on the right in any of these ways:

- **Right-click** a thumbnail and choose *Show to right*. This also works while comparing is off – it then opens at the same time.
- `Shift`+click a thumbnail shows the page in the pane that is *not* active: on the right when the left page is active (or when the comparison is off – then it opens), on the left when the right page is active. The active page does not change.
- `Arrow Right` opens the comparison just like the button – the first time with the page you are looking at on the right, later with the page you last compared with – or makes the right page active if the comparison is already on.



Right-clicking a thumbnail. *Show to right* (*Visa till höger*) puts the page on the right in the comparison.



Compare mode. Left page blue, right page orange. The ring at the top left of each page shows which one is active, and in the pane the left page is marked **V** and the right page **H** (Swedish for left and right).

One of the pages is always **active** – the one you last clicked in. The active page's ring is filled, like a radio button, and you can click a ring to make that page active. The toolbar's page box and browsing buttons, the keyboard and the image adjustments apply to the active page. The frames around the buttons show which page is being controlled: blue for left, orange for right.

▾ Controlling the other page without switching

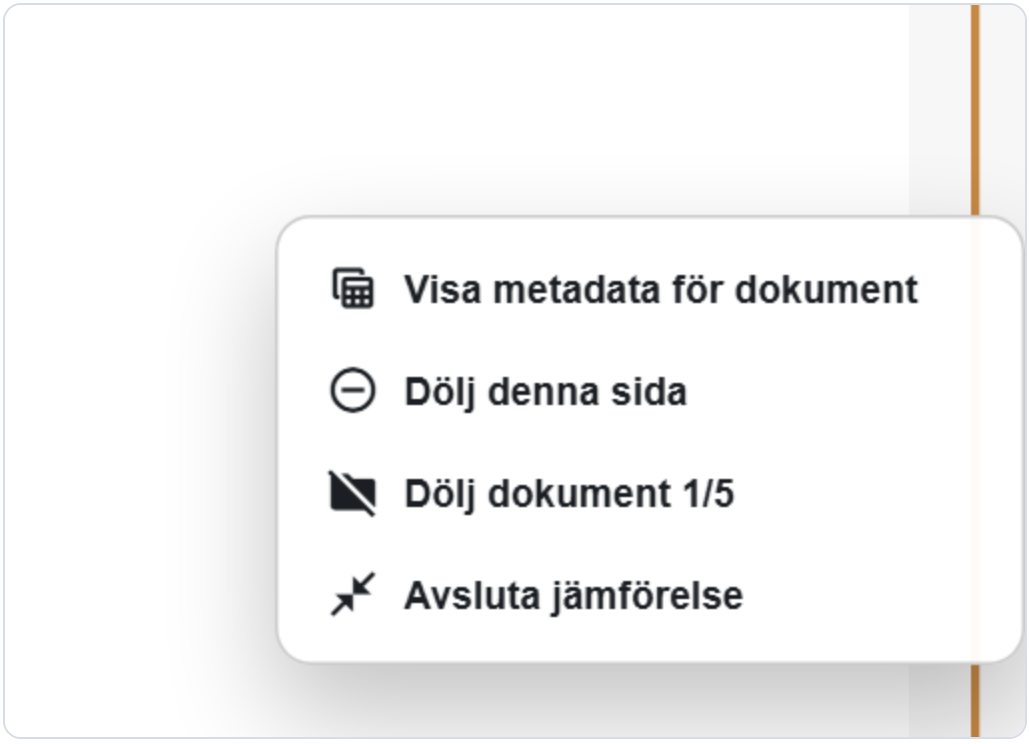
Hold `Shift` while you click a button or use the keyboard, and the command applies to the page that is *not* active – one click or key press at a time. The frames change colour while you hold Shift, so you can see what will happen.



Shift held down. Orange frames = the buttons control the right page right now.

`Arrow Left` makes the left page active and `Arrow Right` the right page. `Ctrl` + `Arrow Left` / `Arrow Right` turns the controlled page a quarter turn.

End the comparison with the compare button (*Disable compare mode*), with `Arrow Left` when the left page is already active, or with *Close comparison* in the right-click menu on the right page. What you fine-tuned is still there if you switch comparing on again.



Right-clicking the right page. The usual options, plus *Close comparison* (*Avsluta jämförelse*).

2. Calibrate – so that the pages line up

Two pages to be compared rarely lie exactly alike: one may be slightly shifted, slightly tilted or scanned at a different scale. **Calibration** is ODV's word for the adjustments you make per page so that they line up – zoom, position and rotation, plus the image adjustments brightness, contrast, grayscale and invert. You make them in the *Fine-tune* panel (section 3), and they follow the pages between the compare view, the overlay view and the curtain view.

- **The calibration belongs to the page.** If you switch page in a pane and then back, the adjustments are still there. A page you have not touched is unadjusted. If you load new documents, everything starts over. Nothing is saved to disk or server.
- The comparison counts as **calibrated** once you have opened the overlay view. Until then the curtain button in the toolbar is grey, and its tooltip says *Curtain: open the overlay view first – it calibrates the two pages*. If you end the comparison, or the right page disappears, you need to open the overlay view again before the curtain can be opened.
- When you open the overlay view, ODV takes a **snapshot** of both pages' adjustments. The button *Reset to the alignment from the compare view* in the overlay view goes back to it.
- **Copy the calibration** in the overlay view puts both pages' values on the clipboard as text (JSON), so you can paste them into a support case. ODV does not read the text back.



The toolbar in compare mode. Fine tuning, compare (on), overlay and curtain. The curtain button is grey until you have calibrated the pages in the overlay view.

3. Fine-tune each page

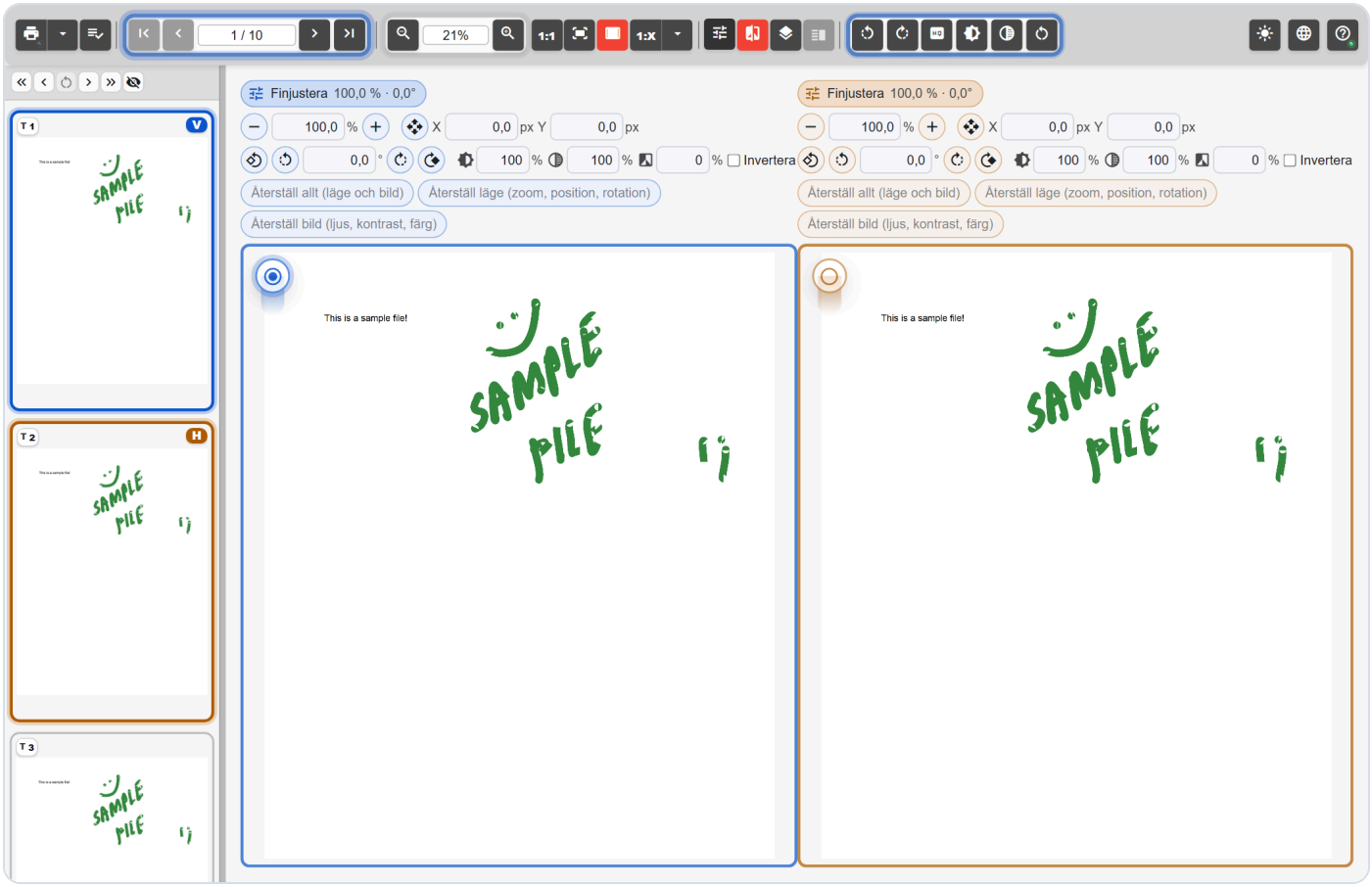
Click **Fine tuning** in the toolbar (the button with the sliders, next to the compare button). A **Fine-tune** panel is then shown above each page – both pages in compare mode, or the single page when you are not comparing. The button starts off; switching it on expands both panels. Switching it off hides the controls and gestures again, but the adjustments are kept.

The panel's header shows a summary, for example *100.0 % · 0.0°*, and the sign ◐ when the image is adjusted. Click the header to expand or collapse the panel. Expanded, it has

four groups:

- **Zoom** in percent with one decimal, 10–800. The − and + buttons change it by 0.1 % (with `Shift`: 1 %). The percentage is applied on top of the shared zoom in the toolbar.
- **Position**: horizontal and vertical offset in pixels. Drag the page with the mouse, or select the move button (four arrows) and use the arrow keys: 1 px per press, 10 px with `Shift`.
- **Rotation** in degrees with one decimal. The ↺ and ↻ buttons turn the page 0.1° (with `Shift`: 1°). A small counter-clockwise tilt shows as a negative number, for example −0.3. The ↺90 and ↻90 buttons in the panel turn a quarter turn and keep the fine tuning – 4.6° becomes 94.6° – and so do the 90° buttons in the toolbar and `Ctrl` + `Arrow Left` / `Arrow Right`.
- **Image**: brightness and contrast 0–200 (100 = unchanged), grayscale 0–100 (0 = in color) and the *Invert* checkbox. The steps are 1, with `Shift` 10.

At the bottom there are three resets: **Reset all (layout and image)**, **Reset layout (zoom, position, rotation)** and **Reset image (brightness, contrast, color)**. A button is grey when there is nothing to reset. In compare mode the toolbar's reset button does the same as *Reset all*, and the toolbar's brightness and contrast buttons show the controlled page's value.



The Fine-tune panel. Zoom, position, rotation and image for one page, and at the bottom the three resets.

You can type into the fields with a decimal comma or a decimal point – 12,5 and 12.5 both work. `Enter`, or leaving the field, applies the value. `Esc` undoes what you typed, and `Arrow Up` / `Arrow Down` step the value (with `Shift`: ten steps).

While a page's panel is expanded, you move the page by **dragging** it instead of scrolling, and `Ctrl` + mouse wheel over the page zooms only that page, 1 % per notch. Collapse the panel, or switch Fine tuning off, to scroll and zoom as usual again.

▾ **The zoom buttons behind the ring and the toolbar's zoom**

Each page also has its own zoom buttons, tucked behind the coloured ring at the top left: point at the ring (or tab to it) and they fold out below it – zoom in, the factor (for example ×1.0) and zoom out. Each click changes the page's zoom by ten percent of the base zoom and keeps the fine tuning. The toolbar's *Fit to screen*, *Fit to width*, *1:1* and *1:X* reset both pages' own zoom but keep position and rotation.

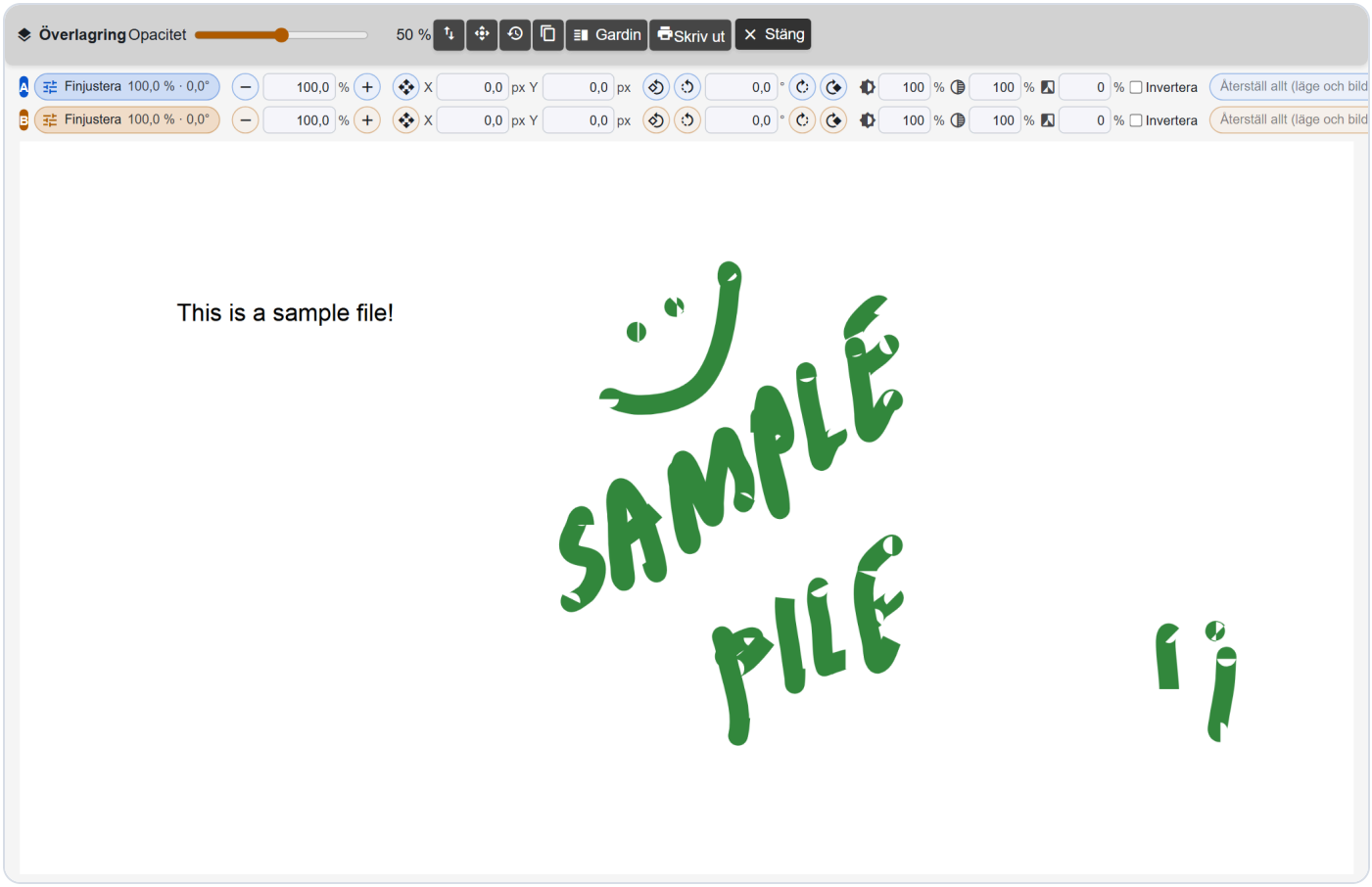


The ring with the zoom buttons folded out.

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4. Lay the pages on top of each other (overlay)

Small differences are easiest to see when the pages lie on top of each other. Click the **overlay button** (stacked layers) next to the compare button – it is only there while two pages are compared. The overlay view takes over the whole window, with its own toolbar in place of the usual one. Page A (the left page, blue) lies underneath and page B (the right page, orange) on top. Both keep their calibration, and page A sets the shared zoom.



The overlay view. The *Opacity* slider controls the top page. The panels *A* and *B* are the same Fine-tune panels as in the compare view.

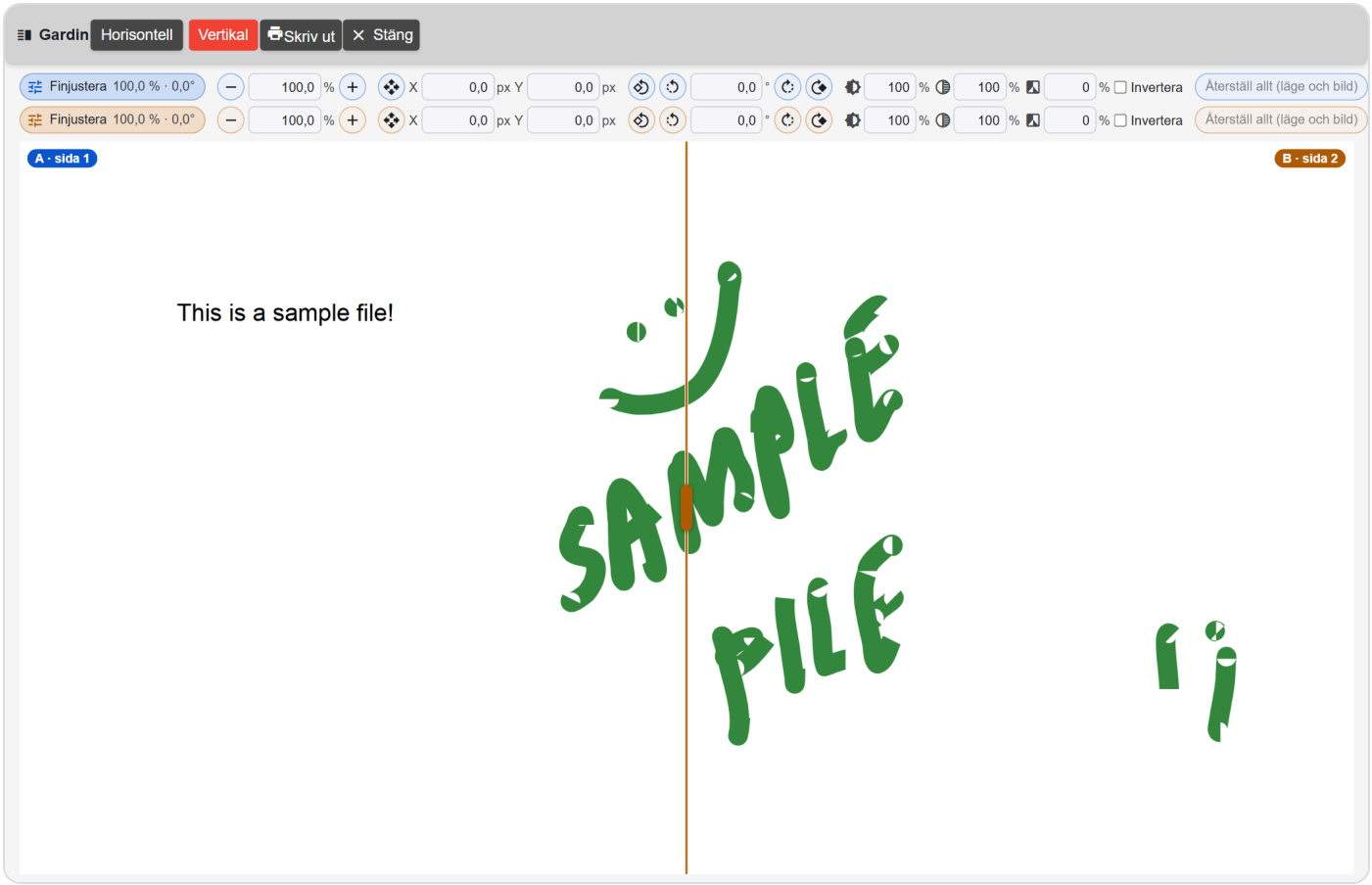
- **Opacity**: the slider sets how visible the top page is, from 0 % (invisible) to 100 % (fully opaque). It starts at 50 %. With the slider selected, `Arrow Left` / `Arrow Right` (or `Arrow Down` / `Arrow Up`) change it by 1 %, with `Shift` by 10 %, and `Home` / `End` go to 0 % and 100 %.
- **Swap which page is on top** (up and down arrows) puts the other page on top. The slider always controls the page on top.
- **Calibrate**: the panels *A* and *B* above the pages are always expanded here, regardless of the choice in the usual toolbar. Dragging the pages moves the top page, and `Ctrl` + mouse wheel zooms the top page, 1 % per notch.
- **Nudge mode** (the move button): while it is on, the arrow keys move the top page 1 px (with `Shift`: 10 px). If the cursor is in a field, the keys go there instead – click outside the field first.
- **Reset to the alignment from the compare view** restores both pages' zoom, position, rotation *and* image adjustments as they were when you opened the overlay view.

- **Copy the calibration as JSON** puts both pages' settings on the clipboard for a support case. *Calibration copied* is shown for a moment.
- **Curtain** opens the curtain view with the same calibration, see section 5. **Print** is described in section 6.
- **Close** – or `Esc`, except while the cursor is in a text field – takes you back to the compare view. The calibration is kept, and the next time you open the overlay view the opacity and the top page are as you left them.

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5. Drag a border between the pages (curtain)

In the curtain view the two calibrated pages lie in the same place, and a border you drag decides where you see which page: page A on one side of the border and page B on the other. This shows quickly whether lines and text continue unbroken across the border.



The curtain view. Page A to the left of the border, page B to the right. The labels in the corners show which page, with its page number, is where.

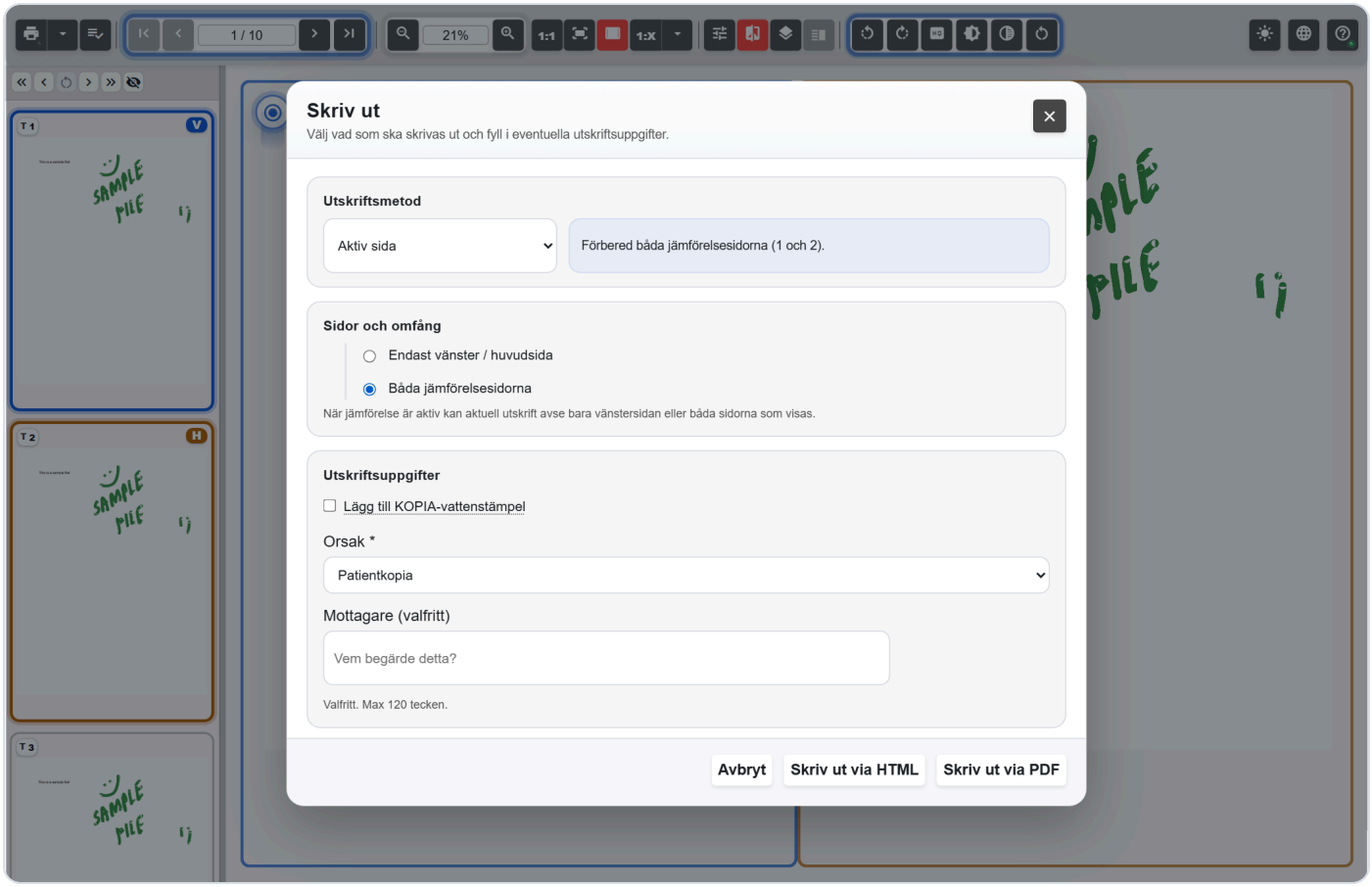
- **Open**: click **Curtain** in the overlay view's toolbar. In the compare view the curtain button sits next to the overlay button; it is grey until you have calibrated the pages in the overlay view (section 2). If the overlay is switched off for the installation, the curtain uses the compare view's calibration directly.
- **Horizontal / Vertical** chooses the direction of the border. Vertical: the border is upright, page A shows on the left and page B on the right. Horizontal: the border is level, page A shows above and page B below. The view always opens vertical with the border at 50 %, and each direction remembers its own position while the view is open.
- **Move the border**: drag the grip on the border with the mouse or a finger. The grip is selected when the view opens, so the `arrow keys` move it at once: 1 % per press, 10 % with `Shift`.
- **Fine-tune**: the panels *A* and *B* are expanded here too and change the same calibration as the compare view and the overlay view – the adjustments stay when you close.
- **Close** – or `Esc` – takes you back to where you opened the curtain view: the overlay view or the compare view.

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6. Print from the comparison

There are three ways to get the comparison on paper or as a PDF. All of them use ODV's usual print dialog, so reason, recipient, watermark and the choice between direct print, **Print via PDF** and **Save PDF** work as in the Getting started guide.

Side by side: click the print button in the toolbar and choose the **Active page** method. In compare mode the dialog asks *What should "Active page" mean in compare view? – Left / primary page only* or *Both compare pages*. With both, two pages are printed, exactly as you see them: zoom, position, rotation and image adjustments are included. Every other print method prints the pages as they are in the archive.

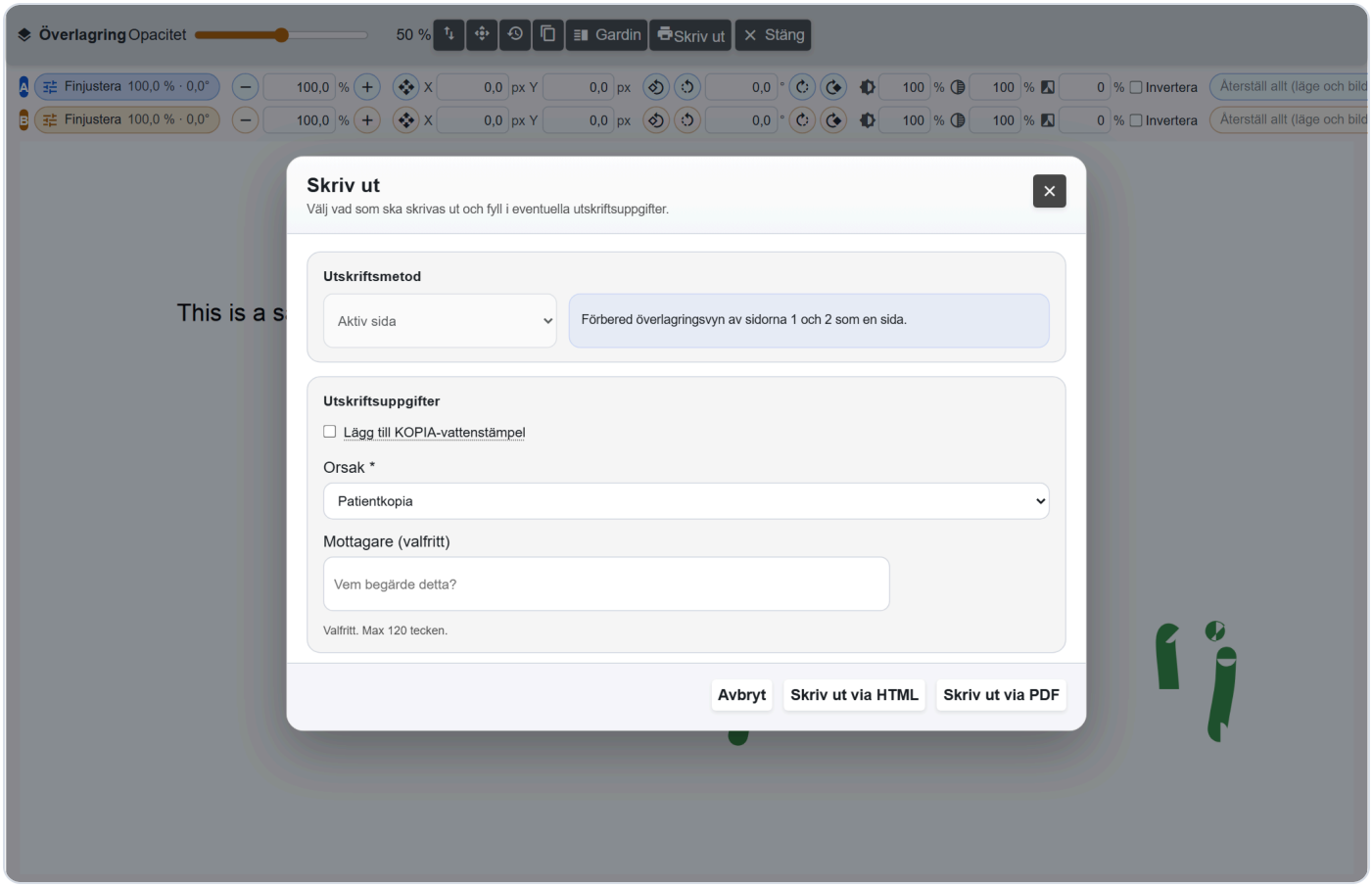


Active page in compare mode. *Both compare pages* gives two pages on the printout.

Print the overlay view: click **Print** in the overlay view's toolbar. You get one composed page of the visible area, with the pages laid on top of each other as on screen: the lower page opaque, the top page at the slider's opacity, and both with their zoom, position, rotation and image adjustments. The toolbar and the slider are not printed.

Print the curtain view: click **Print** in the curtain view's toolbar. You get one composed page of the visible area with the border's direction and position as at that moment, and both pages' calibration. The grip, the corner labels and the toolbar are not printed.

For the two views the dialog is simpler: the print method is locked to *Active page* (greyed out), the *Pages and scope* section is not shown, and the previous print's settings are not offered. The summary says, for example, *Prepare the overlay view of pages 1 and 2 as one page* or *Prepare the curtain view of pages 1 and 2 as one page*. The result is always one composed page, portrait or landscape after the shape of the visible area, with the same header, footer and watermark as other prints, and the print is logged with a page count of 1. The **Print** button in a view is shown only once all pages have loaded, and it is grey while a PDF is being prepared.



Printing from the overlay view. The same dialog as usual, but the method is locked to *Active page*: the result is one page.

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7. What your organisation may have switched off

Everything above is included from the start, but whoever manages the installation can switch parts of it off. If a button described in the guide is missing, that is probably why – ask your local support.

- **Fine tuning, overlay and curtain together.** Then there is no Fine tuning button, no panels, no zoom buttons behind the ring and neither of the two views. Ordinary viewing, side-by-side comparison and its printing remain.
- **The overlay view** or **the curtain view** separately. A switched-off view has no button at all – neither in the toolbar nor in the other view. If the overlay is switched off, the curtain uses the compare view's calibration directly, and the curtain button is never grey.
- **Printing from a view.** The view remains but has no Print button. Side-by-side printing is not affected.

- **The toolbar's image buttons in compare mode.** Normally brightness and contrast show the controlled page's values. An installation can instead let the 90° buttons, brightness, contrast and reset give way while a Fine-tune panel is expanded – the panel has the same controls. The HQ button always remains.

Installation settings in `odv.site.config.js`, for whoever manages the installation: `fineTune.enabled` switches off fine tuning, overlay and curtain together. `compare.overlay.enabled` and `compare.curtain.enabled` control whether each view can be opened. `compare.overlay.print.enabled` and `compare.curtain.print.enabled` control each view's **Print** button. All five default to `true`, and only the boolean `false` switches one off. `compare.adjust.toolbarMode` is `'mirror'` (default: the toolbar shows the page's values) or `'hide'` (the image buttons give way while a panel is expanded).

The keys in the comparison

Key	Does this
`Arrow Right`	Opens the comparison (the first time with the page you are looking at on the right, later with the last compared page), or makes the right page active.
`Arrow Left`	Makes the left page active. When it is already active, the comparison ends.
`Shift` + button or key	Applies to the page that is not active, one click or key press at a time.
`Shift` + click on a thumbnail	Shows the page in the pane that is not active (on the left when the right page is active).
`Ctrl` + `Arrow Left` / `Arrow Right`	Turns the controlled page 90° and keeps the fine tuning.
Arrow keys in the move button	Move the page 1 px, with `Shift` 10 px.
`Enter` / `Esc` / `Arrow Up` / `Arrow Down` in a field	Applies the value / undoes / steps the value (with `Shift`: ten steps).
`Ctrl` + mouse wheel over a page with an expanded panel	Zooms only that page, 1 % per notch.
Arrow keys on the opacity slider	Left/down −1 %, right/up +1 %, with `Shift` 10 %. `Home` 0 %, `End` 100 %.

Key	Does this
Arrow keys in nudge mode	Move the top page 1 px, with `Shift` 10 px.
Arrow keys on the curtain's border	Left/up −1 %, right/down +1 %, with `Shift` 10 %.
`Esc`	Closes the overlay view or the curtain view – not while the cursor is in a text field.

While the overlay view or the curtain view is open, the usual keyboard shortcuts are paused. All keyboard shortcuts in ODV are listed in More features.

Short checklist

- ✓ Blue frame = left page, orange frame = right page. The filled ring shows the active page.
- ✓ *Fine tuning* in the toolbar shows the panels. The adjustments stay when you hide them.
- ✓ Open the overlay view once – then the curtain can be opened.
- ✓ Printing from a view always gives one page. *Active page* with *Both compare pages* gives two.

Back to Getting started with OpenDocViewer. This guide covers OpenDocViewer 2.10.
Updated 2026-10-24.